Machines that notice

IoT · Level 1 · Lesson 1



Today you will

- Explain what a sensor does: it notices something and turns it into a number.
- Match your senses to sensors that do a similar job, and find senses machines have that you don't.
- Follow how a device senses, decides and acts.

Sensors notice

- A sensor notices one thing
- It turns it into a number
- Some sense what we can't
- Sense, decide, act

Sensor hunt

1. Draw a table: device, senses, decides, does
2. Hunt at home: lights, taps, the fridge, a phone
3. Hunt at school and on the way: doors, street lights, tanks
4. Star the ones that sense what people can't
5. Explain your best find to someone

Look, don't open: never take a device apart or touch sockets and mains wires. Ask before you photograph something that isn't yours.

Let’s discuss

1. Which of your senses would be hardest for a machine to copy, and why?
2. When should a person, not a sensor, make the decision?
3. What would you want a sensor in your town to warn people about?

Check yourself

- Name one device near you, and say what it senses, what decides and what it does.